



INSIGHTSMASTERY ACADEMY

POWER BI BOOKMARKS STUDENT HANDBOOK

COMPLETE EDITION

Bookmarks • Selection Pane • Buttons • Navigators
From Absolute Beginner to Advanced

DATA • DISPLAY • CURRENT PAGE • ALL VISUALS • SELECTED VISUALS

Report Bookmarks • Personal Bookmarks • Bookmark Groups

Toggles • Slide-in Panels • Pop-ups • Tabs • Storytelling

14 Step-by-Step Patterns • Troubleshooting • Mini Project

Professional Training Edition

Designed for Classroom & Self-Learning

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1. How to Use This Handbook

This handbook is written as if an experienced teacher is sitting beside you, building a real report with you click by click. You do not need any programming background. Bookmarks need no DAX at all — only a clear idea of **what state** you want to save and **what should change** when a user clicks.

Recommended Learning Path

1. Read Chapters 3–6 in order. They explain what a bookmark saves and the four option switches — the part most people get wrong.
2. Build the practice report in Chapter 2 in Power BI Desktop before starting the patterns.
3. Build every pattern in Chapter 10 yourself. Click the bookmark, then check it against the **Expected behaviour** line.
4. Use the Troubleshooting chapter whenever a bookmark does something unexpected.
5. Finish with the Mini Project and the practice exercises.

Teaching Pattern Used Throughout

For every feature and pattern we follow this exact pattern:

WHAT → WHY → WHERE TO CLICK → OPTION SETTINGS → STEP BY STEP → EXPECTED BEHAVIOUR → COMMON MISTAKE → PRACTICE

How to read an option table

Every pattern ends with a small table of the four bookmark options. **On** means the check mark is ticked, **Off** means it is cleared, **Either** means it does not matter.

Data	Display	Current page	Applies to
Off	On	On	Selected visuals



Bookmarks Roadmap

Stage	Focus	Key Concepts
1. Foundations	What is a bookmark?	Report state, what is saved, report vs personal bookmarks
2. The panes	Where you work	Bookmarks pane, Selection pane, Format button pane
3. First bookmark	Create and manage	Add, rename, update, delete, reorder, View (slide show)
4. Options	Control what is restored	Data, Display, Current page, All vs Selected visuals
5. Visibility	Show and hide objects	Selection pane, eye icon, grouping, layer and tab order
6. Triggers	Let users click	Buttons, shapes, images, bookmark and page navigators
7. Organising	Structure at scale	Bookmark groups, naming conventions
8. Patterns	Real report features	Toggles, panels, pop-ups, tabs, reset, storytelling
9. Service	Readers' bookmarks	Personal bookmarks, default view, limits
10. Mastery	Build with confidence	Alternatives, troubleshooting, mini project

Important Promise

By the end of this handbook you will know not only which buttons to click, but **why** each bookmark behaves the way it does — which state it saves, which it ignores, and how to design bookmarks that never fight your users' filters.



2. Our Practice Report

Throughout this handbook we build one report, **Sales Performance**, on the same Sales table used in the DAX Mastery handbook. Build it once; every pattern adds to it.

Sales ID	Date	Customer	Product	Category	Region	Qty	Sales Amount	Cost	Sales person
1	01-Jan-26	Amit	Laptop	Electronics	North	2	100000	80000	Ravi
2	02-Jan-26	Neha	Mouse	Electronics	South	5	5000	3000	Priya
3	03-Jan-26	Rahul	Keyboard	Electronics	North	3	6000	3500	Ravi
4	04-Jan-26	Amit	Monitor	Electronics	West	2	30000	22000	Amit
5	05-Jan-26	Priya	Chair	Furniture	South	4	20000	14000	Priya
6	06-Jan-26	Rahul	Desk	Furniture	North	1	15000	10000	Ravi
7	07-Jan-26	Neha	Laptop	Electronics	South	1	50000	40000	Priya
8	08-Jan-26	Amit	Chair	Furniture	West	2	10000	7000	Amit
9	09-Jan-26	Rahul	Mouse	Electronics	North	10	10000	6000	Ravi
10	10-Jan-26	Priya	Desk	Furniture	South	2	30000	20000	Priya

2.1 Measures used in the report

```
Total Sales    = SUM( Sales[SalesAmount] )      -- 276,000
Total Profit   = SUM( Sales[SalesAmount] ) - SUM( Sales[Cost] )  -- 70,500
Total Orders   = COUNTROWS( Sales )           -- 10
Total Quantity = SUM( Sales[Quantity] )       -- 32
```

2.2 Page 1 — Overview

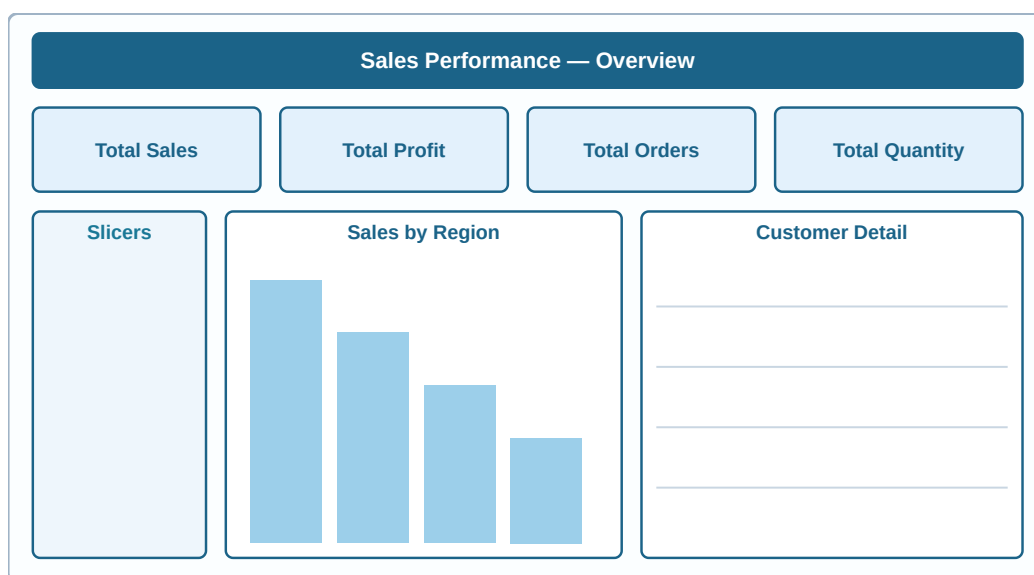


Figure 2.1 — The Overview page before any bookmarks are added



Give every object a clear name now (Format → General → Title, and the Selection pane name). The patterns refer to these names:

Object name	Type	Content
Card – Total Sales / Profit / Orders / Quantity	Card	The four measures
Slicer – Region	Slicer (list)	Sales[Region]
Slicer – Category	Slicer (dropdown)	Sales[Category]
Chart – Sales by Region	Clustered bar chart	Region, Total Sales
Table – Customer Detail	Table	Customer, Product, Total Sales, Total Profit

2.3 Page 2 — Region Detail

A second page with a matrix of **Region × Category** showing Total Sales, and a line chart of Total Sales by Date. It is used to show how the **Current page** option moves users between pages.

Numbers to recognise

Region = North → Total Sales **131,000** · South → **105,000** · West → **40,000** · Category = Electronics → **201,000** · North + Electronics → **116,000**. When a bookmark restores a filter, these are the values you should see on the cards.



3. What Is a Bookmark?

3.1 Simple Meaning

A bookmark is a **saved snapshot of the state of a report page**. When someone selects it, Power BI puts the page back into exactly that state.

Camera Analogy

Think of a bookmark as a photograph of your report settings — not of the data. When you select the bookmark, Power BI rearranges the settings to match the photo, but the numbers are always today's numbers from the model.

3.2 Why Do We Need Bookmarks?

- **Interactivity without code** — show or hide visuals when a button is clicked (toggles, pop-ups, panels, tabs).
- **Saved views** — jump straight to 'North Electronics this month' without re-selecting slicers.
- **Storytelling** — step through insights one by one like a slide show.
- **Reset** — give users a one-click way back to the default view.
- **Personal views** — readers in the Power BI service can save their own filtered views.

3.3 What a Bookmark Saves

According to Microsoft's documentation, a report bookmark stores these elements:

#	Element saved	Example in our report	Controlled by option
1	The current page	Overview or Region Detail	Current page
2	Filters (Filters pane)	Page filter Category = Electronics	Data
3	Slicers, including slicer type and state	Region slicer set to North	Data
4	Visual selection state (cross-highlight)	North bar clicked in the chart	Data
5	Sort order	Customer Detail sorted by Total Sales, descending	Data
6	Drill location	Chart drilled from Region to Customer	Data
7	Visibility of objects (Selection pane)	Table hidden, chart shown	Display
8	Focus or Spotlight mode	Chart shown in Spotlight	Display

3.4 What a Bookmark Does NOT Save

Not saved	What this means for you
Position and size of visuals	Move a visual after creating the bookmark, and the bookmark will not move it back.



Not saved	What this means for you
Formatting (colours, fonts, titles)	Formatting belongs to the visual, not to the bookmark.
The data itself	A bookmark stores settings. After a refresh it shows the new numbers.
Visuals added after the bookmark	A new visual is not part of old bookmarks until you select the bookmark and choose Update.
Slicers added after the bookmark	Adding a slicer to a page that already has bookmarks clears that slicer when those bookmarks are applied.

3.5 Report Bookmarks vs Personal Bookmarks

Aspect	Report bookmark	Personal bookmark
Who creates it	Report author (needs edit permission)	Any report viewer in the Power BI service
Where	Power BI Desktop or the service in Edit mode	Power BI service, while viewing a report
Who sees it	Everyone who opens the report	Only the person who created it
Can control visibility (Display)	Yes	No — captures page, filters, slicers, selection, sort, drill
Can be used by buttons and navigators	Yes	No
Can be grouped	Yes	No
Limits	Part of the report file	20 per report, 2,000 across all reports, expire after 6 months
Default view	—	Can be set as the reader's default view

Teacher Tip

This handbook is mostly about **report bookmarks** — the ones you design. Chapter 11 covers personal bookmarks for your report readers.



4. The Three Panes You Will Use

Bookmark work happens in three panes. Open all three before you start: in Power BI Desktop, select the **View** tab and turn on **Bookmarks** and **Selection**. The Format pane opens when you select a button.

4.1 The Bookmarks Pane

Control	What it does
Add	Creates a bookmark from the current state of the page, with a generic name such as Bookmark 1.
View	Starts a slide show of bookmarks in their pane order (Chapter 5).
More options (...)	Rename, Update, Delete, Group, Ungroup, and the option check marks: Data, Display, Current page, All visuals, Selected visuals.
Drag and drop	Changes the order. A yellow bar shows where the bookmark will land.
Ctrl + click	Selects several bookmarks, for example to group them.

4.2 The Selection Pane

The Selection pane lists every object on the current page — visuals, shapes, buttons, images, text boxes and groups.

Control	What it does
Eye icon	Shows or hides the object. Visibility is what the Display option of a bookmark saves.
Double-click the name	Renames the object. Clear names make bookmark work far easier.
Layer order	Objects higher in the list sit on top of objects lower down. Pop-ups and panels must be at the top.
Tab order	The order keyboard users move through objects. Keep buttons next to what they control.
Group (Ctrl + click, then right-click → Group)	Treat several objects as one — hide or show a whole panel with one click.

Remember

Hidden slicers still filter the page. You can hide a slicer and still let a bookmark set its value — a technique used in several patterns.

4.3 The Format Button Pane (Action)

Any **button**, **shape** or **image** can trigger a bookmark. Select the object, open **Format** → **Action**, turn Action **On**, set **Type** = **Bookmark**, and choose the bookmark.



Action type	What it does	Typical use
Back	Returns to the previous page	Drillthrough and detail pages
Bookmark	Applies a report bookmark	Toggles, panels, pop-ups, reset
Drill through	Opens a drillthrough page for the selected data point	Customer details
Page navigation	Moves to another page	Menus and home buttons
Q&A	Opens the Q&A explorer	Natural-language questions
Web URL	Opens a web page	Documentation, source systems
Apply all slicers / Clear all slicers	Applies pending slicer changes / clears every slicer on the page	Large reports; reset without a bookmark

Desktop tip

In Power BI Desktop, hold **Ctrl** and click a button to test it. In the Power BI service a normal click works.



5. Creating and Managing Bookmarks

5.1 Create Your First Bookmark — Desktop

1. Open the Overview page. Set the Region slicer to **North**.
2. On the **View** tab select **Bookmarks** to open the pane.
3. Select **Add**. Power BI creates *Bookmark 1*.
4. Select **More options (...)** → **Rename** and type **North View**.
5. Clear the Region slicer. Total Sales returns to 276,000.
6. Select **North View** in the Bookmarks pane.

Expected behaviour: the Region slicer is set to North again and Total Sales shows 131,000.

5.2 Create a Bookmark — Power BI Service

1. Open the report and select **Edit**.
2. Select **View** → **Bookmarks pane**.
3. Arrange the page, then select **Add**.
4. Save the report so the bookmark is kept.

You need edit permission on the report to create report bookmarks. Without it you can create personal bookmarks only (Chapter 11).

5.3 Rename, Update, Delete

Action	When to use it	Watch out
Rename	Always — give every bookmark a meaningful name	Button labels in a bookmark navigator follow the bookmark name
Update	After you change what the bookmark should save	Select the bookmark first, change the page, then choose Update
Delete	The bookmark is no longer used	Buttons pointing to it stop working — check actions first

The Update workflow

1. Select the bookmark so the page is in its state. **2.** Make your change (slicer, visibility, sort). **3.** More options (...) → **Update**. If you skip step 1, you overwrite the bookmark with the state of a different bookmark.

5.4 Reordering Bookmarks

Drag and drop bookmarks in the pane. Order matters for the **View** slide show and for the button order in a **bookmark navigator**.



5.5 Bookmarks as a Slide Show (View)

1. Order the bookmarks in the sequence of your story.
2. In the Bookmarks pane select **View**.
3. A caption bar appears at the bottom of the canvas with the bookmark name and arrows.
4. Use the arrows to step through; select **Exit** to finish.

If the selected bookmark is inside a **group**, View plays only that group. If it is at the top level, View plays every bookmark in the report. Slide shows work in Desktop and in the service, in both Edit and Reading view.



6. The Four Bookmark Options — Deep Dive

Every report bookmark has check marks under **More options (...)**. They decide **which parts of the saved state are restored**. Understanding them is the single most important bookmark skill.

Option	Restores	Default
Data	Filters, slicers, cross-highlight selection, sort order, drill location	On
Display	Visibility (Selection pane eye icons) and Spotlight / focus mode	On
Current page	Navigates to the page the bookmark was created on	On
All visuals / Selected visuals	Which objects the Data and Display settings apply to	All visuals

6.1 Data

What

When Data is on, selecting the bookmark re-applies the filters and slicers that were active when it was created or last updated.

When to turn it OFF

Turn Data off for bookmarks that only **switch views** — show a table instead of a chart, open a panel, show help. Otherwise every click silently resets the user's slicers.

Scenario	User has selected	Bookmark 'Show Table' clicked	Data On	Data Off
Chart ↔ Table toggle	Region = South	Table appears	Slicer jumps back to the saved state (e.g. All) — user loses South	Slicer stays on South — correct

When to keep it ON

- Preset views: 'North Electronics'
- Reset / Clear filters bookmarks
- Storytelling slides that must show specific data

6.2 Display

When Display is on, the bookmark restores which objects are visible or hidden, and whether any visual is in Spotlight or focus mode. Turn it off for bookmarks that should change only filters and leave the layout alone — for example a 'Top Customers' filter bookmark on a page with an open panel.

6.3 Current page

When Current page is on, selecting the bookmark takes the user to the page it was created on. When it is off, the bookmark applies its settings to **whichever page is open**.



Current page	Bookmark created on Overview, clicked while on Region Detail
On	User is moved to Overview, then the saved state is applied
Off	User stays on Region Detail; the saved filters are applied to Region Detail

Use case for Current page = Off

A 'Clear Region filter' bookmark shared by several pages — each page gets the same reset without jumping.

6.4 All Visuals vs Selected Visuals

By default a bookmark affects **all visuals** on the page. With **Selected visuals**, it affects only the objects that were selected (Ctrl + click on canvas or in the Selection pane) when you created or updated it. Every other object is left untouched.

How to create a Selected visuals bookmark

1. Set the visibility of the objects you want to control.
2. Ctrl + click those objects in the Selection pane (e.g. Chart – Sales by Region and Table – Customer Detail).
3. Add the bookmark (or Update an existing one) while they are still selected.
4. More options (...) → select **Selected visuals**.

Why Selected visuals matters

Two independent toggles on one page — a chart/table toggle and a filter panel — only work if each bookmark touches only its own objects. With All visuals, opening the panel would also reset the chart/table choice.

6.5 The Decision Table

Goal	Data	Display	Current page	Applies to
Toggle visibility (chart ↔ table, panels, pop-ups)	Off	On	On	Selected visuals
Preset filtered view (e.g. North Electronics)	On	Either	On	All visuals
Reset all filters on this page	On	Off	On	All visuals
Same filter reset on any page	On	Off	Off	All visuals
Story slide (data + layout)	On	On	On	All visuals
Change sort or drill of one visual only	On	Off	On	Selected visuals



7. The Selection Pane — Visibility Mastery

Most interactive bookmark designs are really visibility designs. The Selection pane is where you control them.

7.1 Naming Objects

Default names such as *Clustered bar chart* and *Shape 7* make bookmark work impossible on a busy page. Use a prefix convention:

Prefix	Object	Example
Card –	KPI card	Card – Total Sales
Chart –	Chart visual	Chart – Sales by Region
Table –	Table or matrix	Table – Customer Detail
Slicer –	Slicer	Slicer – Region
Btn –	Button, shape or image with an action	Btn – Show Table
Grp –	Group	Grp – Filter Panel
Bg –	Background shape	Bg – Panel Background

7.2 Show, Hide and Update

1. Click the eye icon next to an object to hide it; click again to show it.
2. Select the bookmark that should remember this visibility.
3. Set the eye icons as you want them for that bookmark.
4. More options (...) → **Update**.

Important

Changing visibility in the Selection pane does not change any bookmark by itself. When you next select a bookmark, visibility snaps back to what that bookmark saved. Always **Update** after changing visibility.

7.3 Grouping

Ctrl + click several objects in the Selection pane, right-click, and choose **Group**. Hiding the group hides every member. Groups keep panels and pop-ups tidy: one eye icon, one Selected visual.

7.4 Layer Order

Objects higher in the Selection pane are drawn on top. A pop-up or slide-in panel must sit **above** the visuals it covers, and its close button must sit above the pop-up background — otherwise the button cannot be clicked.

7.5 Tab Order

The Selection pane also has a **Tab order** view. Keep each button next to the visual it controls, so keyboard and screen-reader users move straight from the button to the content.



7.6 Spotlight and Focus Mode

Select a visual's **More options (...)** → **Spotlight** to fade every other visual. A bookmark with **Display** on remembers the Spotlight, which is ideal for story slides that draw the eye to one chart.



8. Buttons and Navigators

8.1 Button Basics

1. **Insert** → **Buttons** and pick a style (Blank, Back, Information, Bookmark, etc.).
2. **Format** → **Button text**: type a clear label, e.g. **Show Table**.
3. **Format** → **Action**: turn it on, **Type = Bookmark**, choose the bookmark.
4. **Format** → **Tooltip**: explain what happens when the button is clicked.
5. **Ctrl + click** (Desktop) to test.

Button states

State	When it shows	Tip
Default	Normal state	Use the brand colour
On hover	Mouse over the button	Slightly darker fill signals it is clickable
On press	While clicking	Brief visual feedback
Disabled	Action cannot run	Used by drillthrough buttons with no selection

8.2 Bookmark Navigator

A bookmark navigator is a ready-made set of buttons, one per bookmark, that stays in sync with the Bookmarks pane: labels follow bookmark names, order follows pane order, and the selected button shows the last selected bookmark.

1. Create the bookmarks and put them in a **bookmark group** (e.g. Grp – View Tabs).
2. **Insert** → **Buttons** → **Navigator** → **Bookmark navigator**.
3. **Format navigator** → **Bookmarks** → choose the group so only its bookmarks appear.
4. Style the Default, Hover and Selected states; set orientation (horizontal or vertical).

8.3 Page Navigator

Insert → **Buttons** → **Navigator** → **Page navigator** creates one button per page and updates automatically when pages are added, renamed or hidden. Use it for menus; use bookmarks for changes **within** a page.

Accessibility guidance (Microsoft)

Give the navigator meaningful **alt text** naming what it changes (e.g. 'Customer detail view selector'). Place bookmark buttons close to the content they modify, and avoid unrelated focusable objects between them.

Two navigators on one page

A report has only one **active bookmark** at a time. If two navigators control overlapping settings, the highlighted button may not match what is on screen. Make each group control completely separate objects and settings. Also note the navigator's selected state is not reflected in exports.



9. Bookmark Groups

9.1 Create a Group

1. Ctrl + click the bookmarks to group.
2. More options (...) → **Group**. Power BI names it *Group 1*.
3. More options (...) next to the group → **Rename**, e.g. **Overview – Toggles**.

9.2 Groups in View Mode

If the selected bookmark is in a group when you start **View**, only that group is played. If a top-level bookmark is selected, all bookmarks in the report are played.

9.3 Ungroup and Remove One Bookmark

Ungroup on any member removes the whole group (the bookmarks remain). To remove only one bookmark from a group, ungroup, then Ctrl + click the ones you want and **Group** again.

9.4 A Recommended Structure

Group	Bookmarks	Used by
Story – Q1 Review	Story 1 – Total picture, Story 2 – North leads, Story 3 – Laptops drive sales	View slide show
Overview – View Tabs	Tab – Chart, Tab – Table, Tab – Matrix	Bookmark navigator
Overview – Panels	Panel – Open, Panel – Close	Filter panel buttons
Utility	Reset – Overview, Help – Open, Help – Close	Reset and help buttons

Naming convention

Area – Purpose for groups and **Purpose – State** for bookmarks: *Panel – Open, Panel – Close, Tab – Table*. Sorted names read like a map of the report's interactivity.



10. Bookmark Patterns — Step by Step

This is the largest chapter. Each pattern is a real report feature. Build them in order on the practice report — later patterns reuse objects from earlier ones.

10.1 Pattern 1 — Reset All Filters

Why: users apply several slicers and cannot find their way back. One button restores the clean default view.

1. Clear every slicer and Filters-pane filter on the Overview page.
2. Add a bookmark and name it **Reset – Overview**.
3. Set the options below.
4. Insert a **Reset** button (Insert → Buttons → Reset). Action: Bookmark → Reset – Overview.
5. Test: set Region = North (Total Sales 131,000), then Ctrl + click Reset.

Data	Display	Current page	Applies to
On	Off	On	All visuals

Expected behaviour: every slicer clears and Total Sales returns to 276,000; any open panel stays as it was because Display is off.

Alternative without a bookmark

The **Clear all slicers** button action clears every slicer on the page with no bookmark to maintain. Use the bookmark when you also need to reset Filters-pane filters, sort order or drill.

10.2 Pattern 2 — Chart ↔ Table Toggle

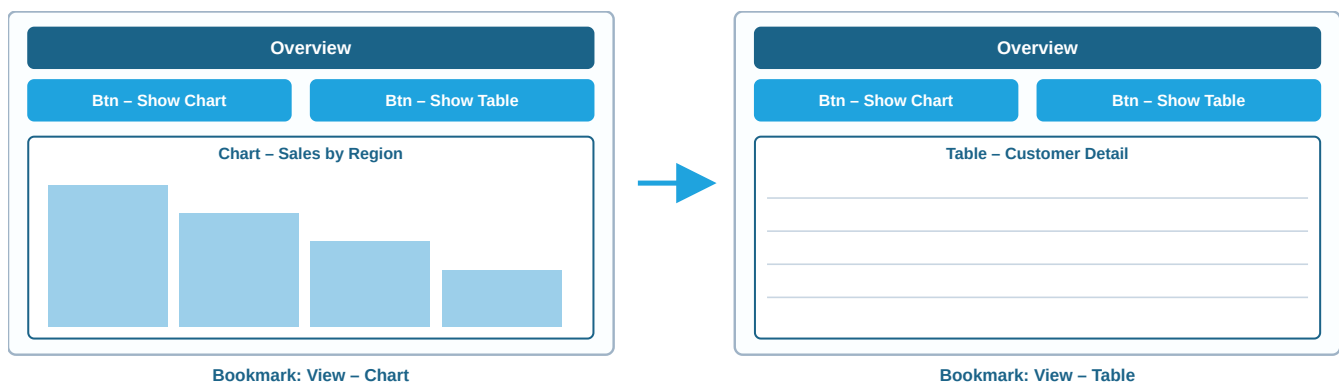


Figure 10.1 — Two bookmarks show one visual at a time in the same space

1. Place the chart and the table in exactly the same position and size.
2. Selection pane: show the chart, hide the table. Ctrl + click both in the Selection pane. Add bookmark **View – Chart**.
3. Show the table, hide the chart. Keep both selected. Add bookmark **View – Table**.
4. For both bookmarks set the options below.
5. Add two buttons: **Btn – Show Chart** → View – Chart, **Btn – Show Table** → View – Table.



Data	Display	Current page	Applies to
Off	On	On	Selected visuals

Expected behaviour: set Region = South, then click Show Table. The table appears with South data only; the slicer stays on South.

Common mistake

Leaving **Data** on. The toggle then resets the Region slicer to whatever it was when you created the bookmark, and users think the report is broken.

10.3 Pattern 3 — Slide-in Filter Panel

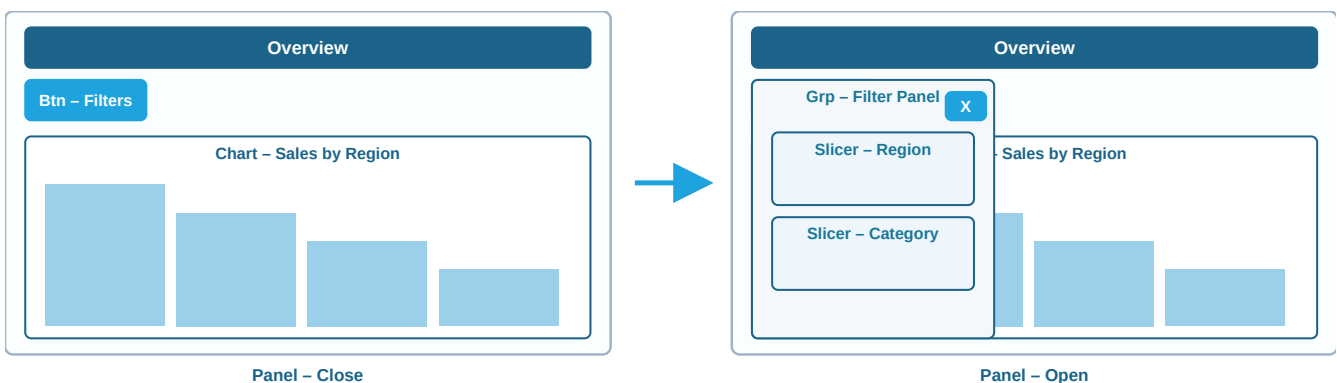


Figure 10.2 — The filter panel slides over the page and closes with an X button

1. Draw a rectangle **Bg – Panel Background**. Place Slicer – Region, Slicer – Category and a small **Btn – Close Panel** on it.
2. Group them: **Grp – Filter Panel**. Move the group to the top of the Selection pane.
3. Show the group; select it; add bookmark **Panel – Open**.
4. Hide the group; keep it selected; add bookmark **Panel – Close**.
5. Options below for both. Btn – Filters → Panel – Open; Btn – Close Panel → Panel – Close.

Data	Display	Current page	Applies to
Off	On	On	Selected visuals (the group)

Expected behaviour: the panel opens and closes; slicer values chosen inside the panel keep filtering the page after it closes.

Hidden slicers keep filtering, so users should see which filters are active. Add a card or text showing the current selection, e.g. a measure `Selected Region = SELECTEDVALUE(Sales[Region], "All regions")`.

10.4 Pattern 4 — Help / Information Pop-up

1. Build a pop-up: a rectangle with a text box explaining the page, plus **Btn – Close Help**. Group as **Grp – Help**, top of the Selection pane.
2. Bookmarks **Help – Open** (group visible) and **Help – Close** (group hidden), both with the group selected.
3. Insert an **Information** button (the 'i' icon) → Help – Open. Btn – Close Help → Help – Close.



Data	Display	Current page	Applies to
Off	On	On	Selected visuals (the group)

Expected behaviour: the help box covers the page and closes without changing any filter.

Tip

Add a semi-transparent full-page rectangle behind the pop-up (transparency 40–60%). It dims the report and stops users clicking visuals behind it.

10.5 Pattern 5 — Tabs Inside a Page with a Bookmark Navigator

1. Place three visuals in the same area: Chart – Sales by Region, Table – Customer Detail, Matrix – Region × Category.
2. Create **Tab – Chart**, **Tab – Table**, **Tab – Matrix**, each showing one of the three, with all three selected.
3. Group them: **Overview – View Tabs**.
4. Insert → Buttons → Navigator → **Bookmark navigator**; Format → Bookmarks → Group = Overview – View Tabs.
5. Style the **Selected** state (brand fill, white text) so the active tab is obvious.

Data	Display	Current page	Applies to
Off	On	On	Selected visuals

Expected behaviour: three tabs above the visual area; the active tab is highlighted and filters are untouched when switching.

10.6 Pattern 6 — Measure Switcher (Sales / Profit / Orders)

1. Create three copies of the bar chart: Chart – Sales, Chart – Profit, Chart – Orders (same position, different measure).
2. Bookmarks **Metric – Sales**, **Metric – Profit**, **Metric – Orders**, each showing one chart, all three selected.
3. Add three buttons, or a bookmark navigator on a group **Overview – Metrics**.

Data	Display	Current page	Applies to
Off	On	On	Selected visuals

Expected behaviour: the same Region bars show 131,000 / 105,000 / 40,000 for Sales, and 31,500 / 28,000 / 11,000 for Profit.

Modern alternative

Field parameters (Modeling → New parameter → Fields) let one chart switch measures through a slicer — one visual to maintain instead of three. Use bookmarks when the alternative views differ in chart type or layout, not just in the measure.



10.7 Pattern 7 — Preset Filtered Views

1. Set Region = North and Category = Electronics. Add bookmark **Preset – North Electronics**.
2. Clear, then set Region = South and Category = Furniture. Add **Preset – South Furniture**.
3. Add a group **Overview – Presets** and a bookmark navigator for it, or individual buttons.

Data	Display	Current page	Applies to
On	Off	On	All visuals

Bookmark	Region	Category	Total Sales	Total Orders
Preset – North Electronics	North	Electronics	116,000	3
Preset – South Furniture	South	Furniture	50,000	2

Expected behaviour: each preset sets both slicers and the cards show the values in the table.

10.8 Pattern 8 — Hidden-Slicer Presets (Advanced)

Why: buttons labelled **All**, **Electronics** and **Furniture** that change the category **without resetting the Region slicer**. The trick: the bookmarks control only a hidden slicer.

1. Add a second Category slicer, **Slicer – Category (hidden)**, and hide it.
2. Set it to Electronics. Select **only this slicer** in the Selection pane. Add bookmark **Cat – Electronics**.
3. Repeat for **Cat – Furniture** and **Cat – All** (slicer cleared).
4. Set the options below. Add three buttons pointing to the three bookmarks.

Data	Display	Current page	Applies to
On	Off	On	Selected visuals (hidden slicer only)

Region slicer	Button clicked	Total Sales
All	Electronics	201,000
All	Furniture	75,000
North	Electronics	116,000
North	All	131,000

Expected behaviour: Data is restored only for the selected hidden slicer, so the visible Region slicer keeps the user's choice.

10.9 Pattern 9 — Storytelling Slide Show

1. Create the story bookmarks in order, each with the data and layout of one insight:
2. **Story 1 – Total picture:** no filters, all visuals (276,000).
3. **Story 2 – North leads:** Region = North, chart in Spotlight (131,000, 47% of sales).
4. **Story 3 – Laptops drive sales:** Product = Laptop, table sorted by Total Sales (150,000 from two orders).
5. Group them as **Story – Q1 Review**, select Story 1, then **View**.



Data	Display	Current page	Applies to
On	On	On	All visuals

Expected behaviour: the caption bar steps through the three insights in order; Exit returns to normal editing.

10.10 Pattern 10 — Spotlight / Focus on One Visual

1. Select Chart – Sales by Region → More options (...) → **Spotlight**.
2. Add bookmark **Focus – Region Chart**.
3. Turn Spotlight off; add bookmark **Focus – Off**.

Data	Display	Current page	Applies to
Off	On	On	All visuals

Expected behaviour: other visuals fade while the chart stays bright; filters remain whatever the user chose.

10.11 Pattern 11 — Sort and Drill Presets

1. Sort Table – Customer Detail by Total Sales, descending (Amit 140,000 first).
2. Select only the table; add bookmark **Sort – Top Customers**.
3. Drill Chart – Sales by Region down from Region to Customer (hierarchy on the axis) and add **Drill – Customers** with only the chart selected.

Data	Display	Current page	Applies to
On	Off	On	Selected visuals

Expected behaviour: the table re-sorts or the chart drills, and other visuals and slicers are not touched.

Sort order and drill location belong to the **Data** part of a bookmark. Selected visuals stops the bookmark from resetting slicers on the rest of the page.

10.12 Pattern 12 — One Reset for Every Page (Current page = Off)

1. On any page, clear the Region slicer (the slicer is synced to all pages with View → Sync slicers).
2. Add bookmark **Reset – Region (any page)** with the options below.
3. Copy the reset button to every page.

Data	Display	Current page	Applies to
On	Off	Off	All visuals

Expected behaviour: clicking Reset on Region Detail clears the filters there, and the user stays on Region Detail.

10.13 Pattern 13 — Background / Theme Toggle

1. Draw two full-page rectangles at the bottom of the Selection pane: **Bg – Light** and **Bg – Dark**.



2. Bookmarks **Theme – Light** and **Theme – Dark**, each showing one background, both rectangles selected.
3. Add a toggle button for each.

Data	Display	Current page	Applies to
Off	On	On	Selected visuals

Expected behaviour: the canvas background switches; visuals and filters stay the same. Visual colours do not change — bookmarks never save formatting.

10.14 Pattern 14 — Active-State Buttons (Manual Tabs)

Before bookmark navigators existed, designers showed the active tab with two versions of each button. It is still useful when you need full control over the look.

1. For each tab make two buttons in the same place: **Btn – Chart (active)** with a dark fill and **Btn – Chart (inactive)** with a light fill.
2. In bookmark **Tab – Chart** show the chart, the active Chart button and the inactive versions of the other buttons.
3. Include every button and every visual in the Selected visuals of each tab bookmark.
4. Point each inactive button to its tab bookmark; active buttons need no action.

Data	Display	Current page	Applies to
Off	On	On	Selected visuals (visuals + all tab buttons)

Expected behaviour: clicking a light tab switches the content and turns that tab dark.



10.15 All 14 Patterns at a Glance

#	Pattern	Data	Display	Page	Applies to
1	Reset all filters	On	Off	On	All
2	Chart ↔ Table toggle	Off	On	On	Selected
3	Slide-in filter panel	Off	On	On	Selected
4	Help pop-up	Off	On	On	Selected
5	Tabs with navigator	Off	On	On	Selected
6	Measure switcher	Off	On	On	Selected
7	Preset filtered views	On	Off	On	All
8	Hidden-slicer presets	On	Off	On	Selected
9	Story slide show	On	On	On	All
10	Spotlight focus	Off	On	On	All
11	Sort and drill presets	On	Off	On	Selected
12	Reset on any page	On	Off	Off	All
13	Background toggle	Off	On	On	Selected
14	Active-state buttons	Off	On	On	Selected

The one-line rule

Changing what users see → Data Off, Display On, Selected visuals.

Changing what data users see → Data On, Display Off.



11. Personal Bookmarks in the Power BI Service

Report readers who cannot edit a report can still save their own views. These **personal bookmarks** are visible only to the person who created them.

11.1 Create a Personal Bookmark

1. Open the report in the Power BI service and set filters, slicers and selections as you like.
2. Select the **Bookmarks** icon → **Show more bookmarks** → **Personal bookmarks** → **Add**.
3. Type a name. Tick **Make default** if this view should open every time.
4. Select **Save**. Use More options (...) to Update, Make default, Rename or Delete.

11.2 What a Personal Bookmark Captures

The current page, filters, slicers (including slicer type), visual selection state, sort order and drill location. It does **not** control visibility — that needs a report bookmark.

11.3 Limits and Behaviour

Rule	Detail
Maximum per report	20 personal bookmarks
Maximum across all reports	2,000 personal bookmarks
Expiry	Personal bookmarks expire after six months
When you can add or update	Only while viewing a report
Grouping	Personal bookmarks cannot be grouped or rearranged, except choosing the default
Mobile apps	Report and personal bookmarks can be used in the iOS and Android apps, but not created there
Report changes	Usually unaffected by republishing; if a field used by the bookmark is renamed or removed, it may show an error or revert
Other pages	A personal bookmark captures only the current page — synced slicer changes on other pages are not saved
Export	Visuals hidden with a personal bookmark may still appear in PDF or PowerPoint exports; use a report bookmark to hide them

Teacher Tip

Show your business users the **Make default** option. A manager who always looks at North Electronics can open the report straight into that view without asking you for a new page.



12. Bookmarks vs Other Features

Bookmarks are powerful, but each bookmark is something to maintain. Choose the simplest feature that does the job.

Need	Best feature	Why not bookmarks?
Switch the measure in one chart	Field parameters	One visual instead of several hidden copies
Move between pages	Page navigator / Page navigation action	Updates automatically as pages change
Show details for a selected item	Drillthrough page	Passes the selected item's filter automatically
Extra detail on hover	Report page tooltip	No click needed
Same slicer value on every page	Sync slicers	Keeps pages consistent without bookmarks
Clear slicers	Clear all slicers button action	No bookmark to update when slicers change
Readers saving their own views	Personal bookmarks	Readers cannot create report bookmarks
Show/hide, panels, pop-ups, stories	Bookmarks	This is where bookmarks shine

12.1 Best Practices

- Name every object and every bookmark before you create the next one.
- Decide Data / Display / Current page / Selected visuals for each bookmark at creation time — use the decision table in Chapter 6.
- Prefer **Selected visuals** for anything that toggles visibility.
- Group bookmarks by purpose; one group per navigator.
- After any layout change, click through every bookmark to test it.
- Keep the number of hidden copies of visuals low; consider field parameters first.
- Add a visible indicator of active filters when slicers live in a hidden panel.
- Document the bookmarks on a hidden 'Read me' page for the next report author.



13. Common Mistakes and Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
Slicers reset when a toggle button is clicked	Data is on in the toggle bookmark	Turn Data off; use Selected visuals
Opening a panel also switches chart back to table	Panel bookmark uses All visuals	Selected visuals = the panel group only
A hidden visual keeps reappearing	Visibility changed but bookmark not updated	Select the bookmark, set visibility, Update
Button jumps to another page	Current page is on and bookmark was created on another page	Recreate on the right page, or turn Current page off
Button does nothing in Desktop	Plain click in Desktop	Ctrl + click in Desktop
Button covered by a shape cannot be clicked	Layer order	Move the button above the shape in the Selection pane
Newly added slicer is cleared by old bookmarks	Documented behaviour for slicers added after bookmarks	Update each bookmark after adding the slicer
Visual is in the wrong place after a bookmark	Bookmarks never save position	Align copies exactly; do not expect bookmarks to move visuals
Navigator highlights the wrong tab	Two navigators control overlapping settings	Make groups control separate objects and settings
Custom visual ignores the bookmark	Visual lacks bookmark support	Ask the visual's author; test with a built-in visual
Deleted bookmark breaks a button	Action still points to it	Check every button action before deleting
Hidden visuals appear in a PDF export	Hidden with a personal bookmark	Use a report bookmark to hide them

13.1 Five-Step Debug Routine

1. Open the Bookmarks and Selection panes side by side.
2. Select the bookmark and watch which eye icons change.
3. Open More options (...) and read the four settings aloud: Data, Display, Current page, All/Selected.
4. Compare them with the decision table in Chapter 6.
5. Fix, Update, and test the whole flow with Ctrl + click.



14. Mini Project — Interactive Sales Performance Report

Build the complete Overview page using the patterns in this handbook. Tick each item as you finish it.

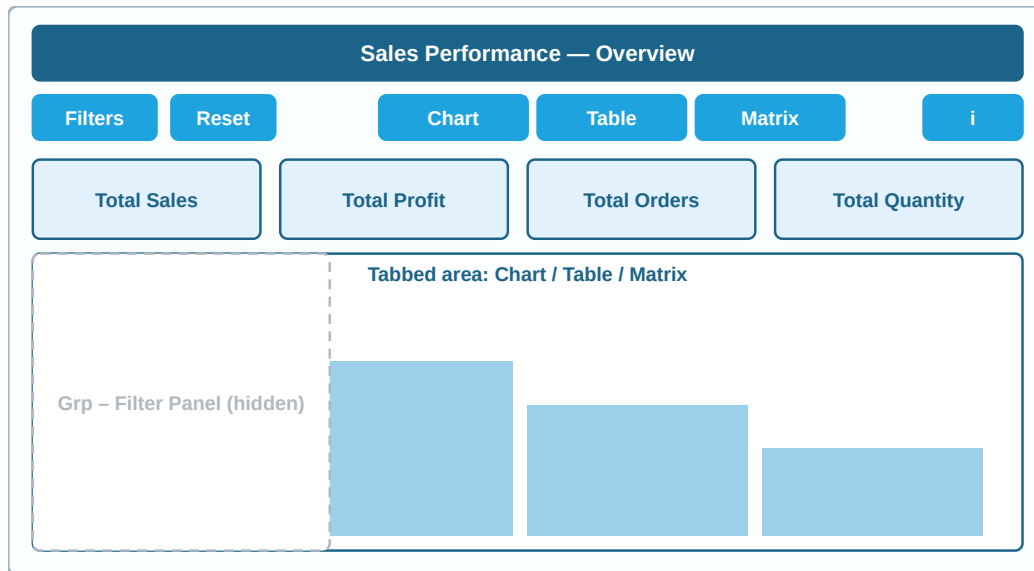


Figure 14.1 — Target layout: filter panel, reset, help, tabbed visual area

- ☐ Cards for Total Sales, Total Profit, Total Orders, Total Quantity.
- ☐ Slide-in filter panel with Region and Category slicers (Pattern 3).
- ☐ Active-filter text: `SELECTEDVALUE(Sales[Region], "All regions")`.
- ☐ Reset button restoring 276,000 (Pattern 1).
- ☐ Chart / Table / Matrix tabs with a bookmark navigator (Pattern 5).
- ☐ Help pop-up with a dimmed background (Pattern 4).
- ☐ Two presets: North Electronics (116,000) and South Furniture (50,000) (Pattern 7).
- ☐ A three-slide story group played with View (Pattern 9).
- ☐ Every object and bookmark named with the conventions in Chapters 7 and 9.
- ☐ Alt text on the navigator; tab order checked.

Acceptance test

Select Region = South, open the Table tab, open and close the filter panel, open and close help. The Region slicer must still say **South** and Total Sales must still show **105,000**. Then click Reset: Total Sales returns to **276,000**.



15. Practice Exercises

For each scenario, write down the four settings (Data, Display, Current page, All / Selected visuals) before you build it. Answers are in the next chapter.

1. A button that shows a map instead of a bar chart without changing filters.
2. A 'Clear filters' button that resets every slicer on the current page only.
3. A bookmark that opens the Region Detail page with Region = West already selected.
4. A pop-up explaining how Profit is calculated.
5. Buttons 'Electronics' and 'Furniture' that change category but keep the user's Region choice.
6. A reset that works identically on all five pages of a report.
7. A three-step story for a management meeting.
8. Sorting the customer table by profit with one click, without touching slicers.
9. Your slicers keep resetting whenever users open the filter panel. What is wrong?
10. A sales manager wants the report to open on 'North only' every time, and cannot edit the report. What do you recommend?



16. Answer Key

#	Data	Display	Current page	Applies to	Notes
1	Off	On	On	Selected (map + chart)	Pattern 2
2	On	Off	On	All	Pattern 1; or the Clear all slicers action
3	On	Either	On	All	Create it on Region Detail with West selected; Region Detail Total Sales = 40,000
4	Off	On	On	Selected (pop-up group)	Pattern 4
5	On	Off	On	Selected (hidden slicer)	Pattern 8
6	On	Off	Off	All	Pattern 12 with synced slicers
7	On	On	On	All	Pattern 9, grouped, played with View
8	On	Off	On	Selected (table)	Pattern 11
9	—	—	—	—	The panel bookmark has Data on and/or All visuals. Turn Data off and use Selected visuals = panel group.
10	—	—	—	—	A personal bookmark in the service with Make default ticked (Chapter 11).



17. Bookmarks Cheat Sheet

Task	Where / How
Open Bookmarks and Selection panes	Desktop: View → Bookmarks, View → Selection · Service: Edit → View
Add a bookmark	Bookmarks pane → Add
Rename / Update / Delete	More options (...) next to the bookmark
Set Data / Display / Current page	More options (...) → tick or clear
Selected visuals	Ctrl + click objects, Add or Update, then More options → Selected visuals
Hide an object	Selection pane → eye icon, then Update the bookmark
Group objects	Selection pane → Ctrl + click → right-click → Group
Group bookmarks	Bookmarks pane → Ctrl + click → More options → Group
Button action	Select button → Format → Action → Type = Bookmark
Test a button in Desktop	Ctrl + click
Bookmark navigator	Insert → Buttons → Navigator → Bookmark navigator → Format → Bookmarks → group
Slide show	Bookmarks pane → View
Spotlight	Visual → More options (...) → Spotlight, then save with Display on
Personal bookmark	Service → Bookmarks icon → Show more bookmarks → Personal bookmarks → Add

Goal	Data	Display	Current page	Applies to
Toggle / panel / pop-up / tabs	Off	On	On	Selected visuals
Preset filtered view	On	Off	On	All visuals
Reset this page	On	Off	On	All visuals
Reset on any page	On	Off	Off	All visuals
Story slide	On	On	On	All visuals

17.1 Sources and Further Reading

Feature behaviour and limits in this handbook follow Microsoft's official Power BI documentation (accessed 30 September 2026):

- Create report bookmarks in Power BI — learn.microsoft.com/power-bi/create-reports/desktop-bookmarks
- Bookmarks in the Power BI service (personal bookmarks) — learn.microsoft.com/power-bi/explore-reports/end-user-bookmarks
- Create page and bookmark navigators — learn.microsoft.com/power-bi/create-reports/button-navigators
- Create buttons in Power BI reports — learn.microsoft.com/power-bi/create-reports/desktop-buttons
- Power BI reports overview — learn.microsoft.com/power-bi/create-reports/power-bi-reports-overview



Continue Your Journey

Next topics: field parameters, drillthrough and report page tooltips, sync slicers, mobile layouts, and report themes. Combine them with bookmarks to build reports that feel like applications.

Congratulations on completing the Power BI Bookmarks Student Handbook.
You now know not only which buttons to click, but why every bookmark behaves the way it does.